a five-year period to be given by agents to friendly officials of the host country.

This was hilarious. Not because the CIA was luring foreign officials with liquor and cigarettes, but because the methods adopted by the spy organisation did not match its image created over the years as the best espionage network across the globe. However, Indian intelligence officers agreed that the CIA came to India's rescue in a limited way whenever a partnership was required. In the aftermath of the 2008 Mumbai attack, the US government and its agencies—the CIA and the FBI—maintained a close working relationship with the Indian government as well as the IB and the R&AW. While the CIA shared intelligence on Pakistan terror groups and the FBI on suspects detained in the USA, the American government gave access to official information received from the Pakistani government to the then National Security Advisor M.K. Narayanan. The intelligence harvested by the CIA from its Pakistani sources was regularly shipped to the R&AW as the Americans were certain that the terror attacks had been carried out by the Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) with the help of the 1ST

Why didn't they do this before the attack? Because for the Americans, the ISI, though tainted and disgraced for breaking laws and sponsoring terrorists, remains its closest ally in South Asia. Despite being faced with the devastating consequences of this friendship in the past, the CIA needs a close ally in the ISI to do its bidding in the subcontinent. An example of the rogue behaviour of the ISI and the subsequent CIA support to the Pakistani agency was exhibited after the 2008 Mumbai attack, in which six Americans were also killed. The CIA knew of the ISI role in the attack but continues to maintain strong ties with the Pakistani agency for long-term gains.